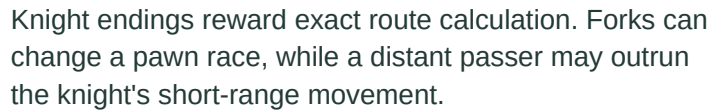


Knight-ending routes

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on f3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

45...Kxa2 The king captures the pawn on a2. Recorded reply: **46.Nc2**.

46...Kb2 The king moves from a2 to b2. Recorded reply: **47.Nd4**.

47...b4 The pawn moves from b5 to b4.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +1: the balance goes from -2 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.